

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF QUEENS

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KEITH RITCHIE,

Plaintiff,

-against-

Plaintiff designates Queens County
as the place of trial

Basis of venue is
county of occurrence

THE CITY OF NEW YORK,
CHARLES GRIMM and
GERARD LYLE,

Defendants.

SUMMONS

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To the above-named defendant(s):

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the plaintiff's attorney within 20 days after service of this summons (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: New York, New York
June 20, 2024

SIVIN, MILLER & ROCHE, LLP

By Edward Sivin
Edward Sivin
Attorneys for Plaintiff
20 Vesey St., Suite 1400
New York, NY 10007
(212) 349-0300

The City of New York: c/o NYC Corp. Counsel, 100 Church St., New York, NY 10006

Lt. Charles Grimm: c/o NYPD Management Orders & Directives Section, One Police Plaza,
New York, NY 10038

P.O. Gerard Lyle: c/o NYPD 104th Pct., 6402 Catalpa Ave, Queens, NY 11385

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF QUEENS

----- X

KEITH RITCHIE,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK,
CHARLES GRIMM and
GERARD LYLE,

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

Defendants.

----- X

Plaintiff, by his attorneys SIVIN, MILLER & ROCHE, LLP, as and for his
complaint herein, alleges as follows, upon information and belief:

THE PARTIES

1. That at all times herein mentioned, plaintiff was and is a resident of the County
of Queens, City and State of New York.

2. That at all times herein mentioned, defendant The City of New York
(hereinafter “the City”) was and is a municipal corporation, duly organized and existing under
and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.

3. That at all times herein mentioned, the City operated, controlled, managed, and
maintained the New York Police Department (hereinafter the “NYPD”).

4. That at all times herein mentioned, defendant Charles Grimm (Grimm) was
and is employed by the NYPD as a police lieutenant.

5. That at all times herein mentioned, Grimm was acting within the course and
scope of his employment with the NYPD.

6. That at all times herein mentioned, Grimm was acting under color of state law.

7. That at all times herein mentioned, defendant Gerard Lyle (Lyle) was and is employed by the NYPD as a police officer.

8. That at all times herein mentioned, Lyle was acting within the course and scope of his employment with the NYPD.

9. That at all times herein mentioned, Lyle was acting under color of state law.

10. That prior to the institution of this action, and within ninety days of the accrual of the causes of action herein, a notice of claim and intention to sue was duly served upon and filed with defendants; that this action was not commenced until the expiration of thirty (30) days after such notice of claim and intention to sue was presented and defendants have neglected and/or refused to make adjustment or payment thereon; and this action is being commenced within one year and ninety days after the causes of action accrued herein.

THE FACTS

11. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above as though fully set forth at length herein.

12. That on or about May 7, 2023, immediately outside plaintiff's residence at 85-19 60th Drive, Middle Village, NY, plaintiff was forcibly seized by and/or at the direction of multiple employees of the NYPD (hereinafter referred to collectively as "the officers"), including but not limited to Grimm and Lyle.

13. That during the course of this forcible seizure, the officers, acting collectively and in concert with one another, pointed firearms directly at plaintiff, forced plaintiff against the wall, and handcuffed plaintiff.

14. That the aforesaid seizure of and use of force against plaintiff was done without a warrant and without probable cause or reasonable suspicion to believe that plaintiff had

committed, was committing, or was about to commit a crime.

15. That after forcibly seizing plaintiff, the officers physically detained and searched plaintiff and then entered and searched plaintiff's residence without a warrant and without probable cause or reasonable suspicion to believe that the residence contained contraband or evidence of a crime.

16. That following their forcible search and seizure, the officers released plaintiff from their custody without filing any criminal charges against him and without even issuing plaintiff a summons or desk appearance ticket.

17. That each of the individual officers observed the illegal and unconstitutional conduct of their fellow officers, each had opportunities to intervene to prevent and/or stop that conduct, and each deliberately failed and refused to do so.

18. That the actions of the officers were intentional and malicious in nature.

19. That as a result of the actions of the officers, plaintiff suffered significant emotional and physical injuries, endured and will continue to endure pain and suffering and loss of enjoyment of life, incurred and will continue to incur medical and other expenses, and has been otherwise damaged.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST ALL DEFENDANTS
(Assault and Battery Under NY State Law)

20. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above as though fully set forth at length herein.

21. That the aforementioned actions of the officers constituted an assault and battery upon plaintiff, for which the officers are liable under NY State law and for which the City is vicariously liable under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST ALL DEFENDANTS
(False Arrest/Imprisonment Under NY State Law)

22. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above as though fully set forth at length herein.

23. That the aforementioned actions of the officers constituted a false arrest and a false imprisonment of plaintiff, for which the officers are liable under NY State law and for which the City is vicariously liable under the doctrine of respondeat superior.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST THE OFFICERS
(42 USC § 1983 Claim Arising from Fourth & Fourteenth Amendment Violations)

24. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above as though fully set forth at length herein.

25. That the aforementioned actions of the officers in searching and seizing, assaulting and battering, and falsely arresting and imprisoning plaintiff constituted illegal searches and seizures of plaintiff, in violation of rights guaranteed to plaintiff under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the U.S. Constitution, and entitle plaintiff to recover damages pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1983.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST ALL DEFENDANTS
(NYC Administrative Code § 8-802)

26. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above as though fully set forth at length herein.

27. That the aforesaid actions of the officers constituted unreasonable searches and seizures and violations of Plaintiff's rights pursuant to NYC Administrative Code § 8-802, and entitle Plaintiff to recover monetary damages under NYC Administrative Code § 8-803.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST THE OFFICERS
(42 USC § 1983 Claim Arising from Failure to Intervene)

28. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above as though fully set forth at length herein.

29. That the aforementioned actions of the officers in failing to intervene to prevent and/or stop the illegal conduct of their fellow officers constituted a violation of rights guaranteed to plaintiff under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the U.S. Constitution, and under the NYC Administrative Code, and entitle plaintiff to recover damages pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1983 and NYC Administrative Code § 8-803.

30. That all of the causes of action herein fall within one or more of the exceptions set forth in CPLR Article 16 with respect to joint and several liability.

WHEREFORE, plaintiff demands judgment against defendants, and each of them, on the foregoing causes of action for compensatory damages in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limitations of all lower courts that otherwise would have jurisdiction over this matter, and for punitive damages against the officers, and attorney's fees against all defendants pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988 and NYC Administrative Code § 8-805, and plaintiff also demands the costs and disbursements of this action.

Dated: New York, New York
June 20, 2024

Yours, etc.
SIVIN, MILLER & ROCHE, LLP

By Edward Sivin
Edward Sivin
Attorneys for plaintiff
20 Vesey St., Suite 1400
New York, NY 10007
(212) 349-0300

VERIFICATION

EDWARD SIVIN, an attorney duly admitted to practice law in the State of New York, hereby affirms the following, under penalty of perjury:

That I am the attorney for the plaintiff(s) in the within action.

That I have read the foregoing complaint and know the contents thereof; that the same is true to my own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be upon information and belief; and as to those matters I believe it to be true.

That the reason this verification is made by your affirmant and not by the plaintiff(s) is that plaintiff(s) does not reside in the County where your affirmant maintains his office.

That the grounds for your affirmant's belief as to all matters not stated upon my knowledge are as follows: records, reports, facts and documents contained in plaintiff(s) file maintained by your affirmant's office.

Dated: New York, New York
June 20, 2024

Edward Sivin

EDWARD SIVIN